

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in legal file and document management, hearing preparation, client communication and drafting, gained at BCLP, Citizens Advice and Q-Legal. Experienced in maintaining organised case records, meeting external deadlines across competing matters, preparing bundles and correspondence, and advising clients on procedural requirements. Grounded in property law issues through Real Estate Disputes work at BCLP; now looking to develop that foundation in a transactional conveyancing environment.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democratic governance) — 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Commercial Law, Company Law, Advanced Contract Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials across multiple property matters
- Conducted legal and factual research on leasehold issues, rights of light, easements and landlord and tenant disputes
- Managed court filings, hearing logistics, matter opening and closure, and deadline tracking across competing matters
- Maintained organised matter records in iManage; handled large volumes of confidential documents accurately under time pressure
- Prepared client notes and cost comparisons; communicated with fee earners and clients on document and procedural requirements

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial
- Drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; amended sections of the Claimant's memorial; conducted legal research
- Became the sole junior supporting the team shortly before a major deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout the matter
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated external translations with a Romanian translator

- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Manages matters from initial client interview through to submission: takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Drafts correspondence, prepares application documents and schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines across concurrent matters
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options in plain terms; regularly communicates complex rules clearly to people under significant personal or financial pressure
- Assesses eligibility against statutory criteria across housing, welfare, employment and debt matters; identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under qualified solicitor supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet a fixed deadline; translated statutory requirements into commercially focused advice

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage document management; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling software; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Hearing bundle preparation, procedural document drafting, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across competing matters, document review, client correspondence